

**We have a very ambitious plan...we have set a target to increase the GI registrations from 605 to 10,000 by 2030**

In the next five years, can we take the story of GI to every state and Union territory, can we take it to every district in this country because there are hidden gems and hidden jewels in the remotest parts of India?

**From granting 6,000 patents in 2014, one lakh patents were granted last year, that's the growth story of India**

It will be a whole-of-government approach, spreading the message of GI products across the nation

**PIYUSH GOYAL**
*Union Minister of Commerce and Industry*

There is no country richer than India when it comes to traditions, customs and heritage. We are a people blessed with immense diversity in our food, textile and handicraft. Protecting and preserving these treasures is of utmost importance, something Union commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal could not emphasise enough at the inaugural INDIA TODAY GI Samagam held in Delhi.

An area that nobody thought worth consideration post-Independence, the intellectual property ecosystem—including patents, copyrights, trademarks and GIs—received a strong push in the Narendra Modi-led regime since 2014. From just 200 GI-tagged products [in 2014], we have 605 today. Similarly, authorised users for GI tags have risen from 365 in 2014 to 29,000 last year. Annual patent grants have surged from 6,000 in 2014 to 100,000 in 2024. "This is the growth story of India," Goyal said.

The aspiration over the next five years, the minister stressed, should be to take the GI story to every state, Union territory and district in the country, given that there are hidden gems in the remotest corners of India. He, in fact, announced an ambitious target: reaching 10,000 GI registrations by 2030. To support this effort, a committee will be notified to oversee the identification of products and the creation of the ecosystem around them.

State governments, district collectors and organisations such as the Spices Board, Tobacco Board, Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority, Development Commissioners of Handicrafts and Handloom, and the Textiles Committee, among others, will also be involved. "It will be a whole-of-government approach, spreading this message across the nation," Goyal said. Bold the target may be, but the minister said it is achievable given the growing interest in these products, guidance from PM Modi and the recent sanction to hire 1,000 personnel in the department. "We will equip them with the most modern technology. Everything is moving online," he said.

On the government's initiatives, the minister mentioned the creation of a dedicated section for GI-tagged products on the Government e-Marketplace. Government departments will be encouraged to procure GI-tagged products. Indian embassies worldwide can also promote ODOP (One District, One Product) and GI products. Additionally, ONDC (Open Network for Digital Commerce) will feature a dedicated section for GI products, and e-tailers will be encouraged to promote traditional Indian items. "There is also a need to promote the GI mark, brand it strongly and establish a simplified mechanism for genuine producers to obtain a hologram mark or similar certification to distinguish authentic products from counterfeits," he said.

Already, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade has collaborated with MasterChef India to promote the unique flavours and culinary traditions of different Indian regions, enhancing the brand value and consumer awareness of GI food products. ■

***- Sonal Khetarpal***